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Repositionable over the scope clip

Abstract

A clipping system includes an adapter, a clip and an extending member. The adapter mounted over an insertion device. The clip mounted over the adapter and includes first and second jaws connected to one another such that the jaws are movable between an insertion configuration and an initial deployed configuration. The first jaw includes a keyhole opening. The member coupled to the clip and adapter. The member includes a distal end releasably engaging the opening. The distal end has a width smaller than a width of a first portion of the opening and larger than a second portion of the opening so that, when a portion of the member proximal of the distal end is received within the second portion, the adapter is released from the clip while the member remains coupled to the clip. The member forces the clip open as the clip retracts over the adapter.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY CLAIM (1) The present disclosure claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/265,178 filed Dec. 9, 2021; the disclosure of which is incorporated herewith by reference.

FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to endoscopic devices and, in particular, relates to endoscopic clipping devices for treating tissue along the gastrointestinal tract.

BACKGROUND

(2) Physicians have become more willing to perform aggressive interventional and therapeutic endoscopic gastrointestinal (GI) procedures, which may increase the risk of perforating the wall of the GI tract or may require closure of the GI tract wall as part of the procedure. Such procedures may include, for example, the removal of large lesions, tunneling under the mucosal layer of the GI tract to treat issues below the mucosa, full thickness removal of tissue, treatment of issues on other

organs by passing outside of the GI tract, and endoscopic treatment/repair of post-surgical issues (e.g., post-surgical leaks, breakdown of surgical staple lines, and anastomotic leaks).

(3) Currently, tissue may be treated via endoscopic closure devices including through-the scope clips or over-the-scope clips. Over-the-scope clips may be particularly useful for achieving closure of larger tissue defects. These endoscopic closure devices can save costs for the hospital and may provide benefits for the patient. In some cases, however, current endoscopic closure devices may be difficult to use, time consuming to position, or insufficient for certain perforations, conditions and anatomies. For example, current over-the-scope clips generally require launching of the clip from a position in which the clip itself is not visible to the operator. That is, prior to clipping the operator may view the target tissue to be clipped and, based on this visualization of the target tissue may determine that the distal end of the device and the clip are in a desired position relative to the target tissue. Based on the observation of the target tissue, the operator then deploys the clip without being able to see the clip itself until it is deployed. Once deployed, such current over-the scope clips are generally incapable of being repositioned.

SUMMARY

(4) The present disclosure relates to a clipping system for treating tissue. The system includes an adapter including a proximal portion configured to be mounted over a distal end of an insertion device and a distal portion extending distally from the proximal portion. The system also includes a clip configured to be mounted over the distal portion of the adapter. The clip includes first and second jaws connected to one another such that the first and second jaws are movable between an insertion configuration, in which the first and second jaws extend about opposing portions of the distal portion of the adapter and are separated from one another to receive tissue therebetween, and an initial deployed configuration, in which the clip is moved distally off of the adapter so that the first and second jaws are drawn toward one another to grip tissue therebetween. The first and second jaws are biased toward the initial deployed configuration and the first jaw including a keyhole opening extending therethrough.

(5) In addition, the system includes a first extending member configured to be releasably coupled to the clip and movably connected to the adapter. The first extending member includes an enlarged distal end configured to releasably engage the keyhole opening of the first jaw. The enlarged distal end has a width which is smaller than a width of a first portion of the keyhole opening and larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening so that, when a portion of the first extending member proximal of the enlarged distal end is received within the second portion, the first extending member is engaged therewithin to permit the withdrawal of the adapter proximally away from the clip while the first extending member remains coupled to the clip to place the system in a review configuration in which the clip is physically separated from the adapter to enhance visual observation of the clip. The first extending member is operable to retract the clip proximally over the adapter so that the clip is forced open as the clip is retracted over the adapter freeing the clip from tissue on which it had been clipper.

(6) In an embodiment, the proximal portion of the adapter includes a first hole extending longitudinally through a wall thereof to slidably receive the first extending member therein, the first hole extending through the wall along a axis that is angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter so that a distal movement of the first extending member relative to the adapter moves the enlarged distal end in a lateral direction relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

(7) In an embodiment, the axis of the first hole intersects the longitudinal axis of the adapter at a point distal of a distal end of the adapter so that, when the first extending member is moved distally relative to the adapter, the enlarged distal end is moved in an inward lateral direction toward the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

(8) In an embodiment, the second portion of the keyhole extends from the first portion toward an exterior edge of the first jaw.

(9) In an embodiment, the enlarged distal end of the first extending member is ball shaped.

(10) In an embodiment, the first portion of the keyhole is substantially circular and the second portion of the keyhole is slotted.

(11) In an embodiment, the system further includes a second extending member configured to be releasably coupled to the second jaw of the clip via a keyhole opening extending through the second jaw, the second extending member including an enlarged distal end configured to releasably engage the keyhole opening of the second jaw, the enlarged distal end of the second extending member having a width that is smaller than a width of a first portion of the keyhole opening of the second jaw and larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening of the second jaw.

(12) In an embodiment, the adapter includes a second hole extending longitudinally through the wall thereof to slidably receive the second extending member therein, the second hole extending through the wall along a axis that is angled with respect to the longitudinal axis of the adapter so that a distal movement of the second extending member relative to the adapter moves the enlarged distal end in a lateral direction relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

(13) In addition, the present disclosure relates to a clipping system for treating tissue which includes an endoscope extending longitudinally from a proximal end to a distal end. The system also includes an adapter including a proximal portion and a distal portion, the proximal portion configured to be mounted over the distal end of the endoscope so that a channel of the adapter is aligned with a channel of the endoscope. Furthermore, the system includes a clip configured to be mounted over the distal portion of the adapter, the clip including first and second jaws connected to one another such that the first and second jaws are movable between an insertion configuration, in which the first and second jaws extend about opposing portions of the distal portion of the adapter and are separated from one another to receive tissue therebetween, and an initial deployed configuration, in which the clip is moved distally off of the adapter so that the first and second jaws are drawn toward one another to grip tissue therebetween, the first and second jaws being biased toward the initial deployed configuration, each of the first and second jaws including a keyhole opening extending therethrough.

(14) The system further includes first and second extending members configured to be releasably coupled to the clip and movably connected to the adapter, each of the first and second extending members extending from a proximal end accessible a user to an enlarged distal end configured to releasably engage the keyhole opening of a corresponding one of the first and second jaws, the enlarged distal end of each of the first and second extending members having a width which is smaller than a width of a first portion of the keyhole opening of the corresponding one of the first and second jaws and larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening of the corresponding one of the first and second jaws so that, when a portion of the first and second extending members proximal of the enlarged distal ends is received within the second portion of the keyhole openings, the first and second extending members engage the clip so that a longitudinal movement of the first and second extending members relative to the endoscope moves the clip between the insertion configuration, the initial deployed configuration and a review configuration in which the clip is physically separated from the adapter to enhance visual observation of the clip.

(15) In an embodiment, the proximal portion of the adapter includes first and second holes extending longitudinally through a wall thereof to slidably receive the first and second extending members, respectively, therein, each of the first and second holes extending through the wall along a axis that is angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter so that a distal movement of the first and second extending members relative to the adapter moves the enlarged distal ends of the first and second extending members in a lateral direction relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

(16) In an embodiment, central axes of the first and second holes intersect the longitudinal axis of the adapter distally of the adapter so that, when the first and second extending members are moved distally relative to the adapter, the enlarged distal ends are moved laterally inward toward the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

- (17) In an embodiment, the second portion of each of the keyholes extends from the first toward an exterior edge of a corresponding one of the jaws.
- (18) In an embodiment, the system further includes first and second outer shafts extending along the endoscope and configured to slidably receive the first and second extending members, respectively, therein, each of the first and second outer shafts extending from a proximal end to a distal end attached to the adapter in alignment with a corresponding one of the first and second holes.
- (19) In an embodiment, the system further includes a user interface connected to the proximal ends of the first and second outer shafts and the proximal ends of the first and second extending members.
- (20) In an embodiment, the user interface includes a handle member and a spool slidably mounted thereover, the handle member attached to the proximal end of the first and second outer shafts and the spool connected to the proximal ends of the first and second extending member so that a longitudinal movement of the spool relative to the handle member correspondingly moves the clip relative to the endoscope.
- (21) In addition, the present disclosure relates to a method for treating tissue. The method includes comprising: inserting a clip to a target area in a body lumen via an endoscope, the clip mounted over a distal end of the endoscope, via an adapter, in an open insertion configuration in which jaws of the clip are separated from one another; drawing tissue into a channel of the adapter and between jaws of the clip; moving the clip from the open insertion configuration toward an initial deployed configuration by releasing a tension along extending members coupled to the clip so that the jaws revert to a biased closed configuration, in which the jaws extend toward one another to grip the tissue received therebetween, the extending members releasably coupled to the clip via enlarged distal ends releasably engaged to keyhole openings extending through each of the jaws, the enlarged distal end of each of the extending members having a width smaller than a first portion of a corresponding one of the keyhole openings and larger than a second portion of the corresponding one of the keyhole openings; and drawing the endoscope proximally away from the clip, while the extending members remain coupled to the clip, toward a review configuration in which a visualization of the clip via the endoscope is enhanced.
- (22) In an embodiment, when it is determined that the clip requires repositioning, moving the extending members proximally relative to the endoscope until the clip is drawn proximally over the adapter toward the open insertion configuration and repositioning the clip over the target tissue.
- (23) In an embodiment, the method further includes moving the clip from the review configuration toward a final deployed configuration by moving the extending members distally through holes extending through the adapter, the holes extending through the adapter along central axes angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter so that, moving the extending members distally relative to the adapter causes the enlarged distal ends thereof to be moved laterally relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter to disengage the extending members from the keyhole openings.
- (24) In an embodiment, during movement of the clip from the review configuration toward the final deployed configuration, each of the extending members are moved from the second portion toward the first portion of a corresponding one of the keyholes so that the enlarged distal end is passed proximally through the first portion to release the clip.
- (25) In an embodiment, during movement of the clip from the review configuration toward the final deployed configuration, the enlarged distal ends of the extending members are moved laterally inward toward one another to disengage the enlarged distal ends from the keyhole openings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION

- (1) FIG. 1 shows a perspective view of a distal portion of a system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (2) FIG. 2 shows a partially transparent longitudinal side view of a distal end of the system according to FIG. 1;
- (3) FIG. 3 shows a perspective view of a clip according to the system of FIG. 1;
- (4) FIG. 4 shows an adapter and a clip during a movement of the clip between an initial deployed configuration and a review configuration according to the system of FIG. 1;
- (5) FIG. 5 shows the adapter and the clip during a movement of the system from the review configuration toward a final deployed configuration;
- (6) FIG. 6 shows a perspective view of a user interface according to the exemplary embodiment shown in FIG. 1;
- (7) FIG. 7 shows transparent longitudinal side view of the user interface according to the system of FIG. 1;
- (8) FIG. 8 shows an enlarged transparent, perspective view of the user interface of the system of FIG. 1;
- (9) FIG. 9 shows an enlarged transparent, longitudinal side view of the user interface according to the system of FIG. 1; and
- (10) FIG. 10 shows a perspective view of an adapter and a clip according to a further embodiment during movement of the system from a review configuration toward a final deployed configuration.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (11) The present disclosure may be further understood with reference to the following description and the appended drawings, wherein like elements are referred to with the same reference numerals. The present disclosure relates to a clipping system and, in particular, relates to an over-the-scope endoscopic clipping system, in which an initial placement of a clip may be viewed and adjusted prior to a final deployment thereof. Exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure comprise a clip mountable over a distal end of an endoscope via an adapter and releasably coupled to extending members so that the clip may be moved between an insertion configuration, an initial deployed configuration, and a review configuration, in which the clip can be viewed prior to being finally deployed.
- (12) According to an exemplary embodiment, each of the extending members include an enlarged distal end configured to be releasably coupled to a keyhole shaped opening extending through a portion of a corresponding one of the jaws. The enlarged distal ends of each of the extending members is smaller than a first portion of the keyhole opening but larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening so that the enlarged distal end may be inserted distally through the first portion and moved laterally into the second portion so that a portion of the extending member proximal of the enlarged distal end engages the second portion of the keyhole. While the extending members are engaged with the keyholes of the clip, the extending members may be moved longitudinally relative to the endoscope to move the clip between the insertion configuration, the initial deployed configuration and the review configuration.
- (13) In the insertion configuration, the clip is mounted with jaws spread open over the adapter in a proximal position maintained in the insertion configuration ready to receive tissue between jaws thereof while the clip's position minimizes its occlusion of the field of view of the endoscopic vision system. The insertion configuration is configured to facilitate insertion of the endoscope to a target site adjacent to tissue to be clipped while the system allows the clip to be deployed and clipped over tissue in an initial deployed configuration. The device permits the endoscope to be withdrawn proximally away from the clip and the tissue over which it is clipped while the clip remains coupled to the device in a review configuration.
- (14) As the endoscope is withdrawn proximally while the clip remains in place over the target

tissue, the field of view of the vision system of the endoscope widens to show the clip and the tissue clipped thereby so that the operator can determine whether the position of the clip is desirable or in need of adjustment. If the operator determines that the clip is positioned as desired, the clip is deployed by releasing the clip from the hooked distal of the extending members and left in place clipped over the target tissue. If the operator determines that the position of the clip needs adjustment, the endoscope and the adapter coupled thereto are moved distally to a position adjacent to the clip. The clip is then drawn proximally over the adapter to reopen the clip which is drawn proximally over the distal end of the adapter forcing the clip to open against its natural bias as the clip slides proximally back over the adapter to return to the insertion configuration. After the clip has been removed from the tissue and returned to the insertion configuration, the operator can reposition the endoscope and device as desired, draw target tissue into the adapter (e.g., under suction or a grasper applied via a working channel of the endoscope) and once more deploy the clip from the adapter over the target tissue in the initial deployed position.

(15) The endoscope is then withdrawn proximally once again as the clip remains coupled to the device so that the device moves again into the review configuration. The position of the clip and the clipped tissue are again observed and, this process may be repeated until the clip is positioned as desired. When the operator sees that the tissue over which the clip is closed is the desired portion of tissue, the clip may be deployed and released from the device and endoscope by moving each of the extending members toward the first portion of the keyhole so that the enlarged distal end of each extending members may be released from the clip by being moved proximally through the first portion of the keyhole, as described below. It will be understood by those of skill in the art that terms proximal and distal, as used herein, are intended to refer to a direction toward and away from, respectively, a user of the device.

(16) As shown in FIGS. **1-10**, a clipping system **100** for treating tissue defects and/or perforations according to an exemplary embodiment comprises a clip **102** configured to be inserted through, for example, a body lumen to a target area to clip a target tissue thereof. The clip **102** is insertable to the target area via an insertion device **104** which may be, for example, a flexible endoscope **106**. As shown in FIGS. **1-5**, the clip **102** is coupled to a distal end **108** of the endoscope **106** via an adapter **110** mounted over the distal end **108** of the endoscope **106** and is movable relative to the endoscope **106** via extending members **112**, to which the clip **102** is releasably coupled. Each of the extending members **112** includes an enlarged distal end **116** that is configured to be releasably engaged with a portion of a corresponding one of the jaws **114** of the clip **102** to facilitate movement of the clip **102** relative to the endoscope **106** between an insertion configuration (e.g., FIG. **2**), an initial deployed configuration (e.g., FIG. **4**), a review configuration (e.g., FIG. **4**), and a final deployed configuration (e.g., FIG. **5**).

(17) According to one embodiment, the enlarged distal end **116** of each of the extending members **112** is configured to releasably engage an opening **118** (e.g., a key-hole shaped opening) extending through a corresponding one of the jaws **114**. In particular, as will be described in further detail below, the enlarged end **116** is insertable through a first portion **124** of the opening **118** and engageable with a second portion **126** of the opening **118** so that movement of the extending members **112** relative to the endoscope **106** correspondingly moves the clip **102** relative to the endoscope **106**. In the insertion configuration, the clip **102** is mounted over the adapter **110** with jaws **114** separated from one another to receive tissue therebetween. To move the clip **102** from the insertion configuration toward the initial deployed configuration, the extending members **112** are moved distally relative to the endoscope **106**, moving the clip **102** distally over and off of the adapter **110** to a closed configuration, in which the jaw **114** move toward one another to grip tissue that has been drawn into the adapter **110** between the jaws **114** when the jaws were in the insertion configuration.

(18) When tissue has been clipped by the jaws **114** in the initial deployed configuration, the clip **102** may then be moved toward the review configuration by moving the extending members **112**

further distally away from the endoscope **106** (or drawing the endoscope **106** proximally relative to the extending members **112**) so that the clip **102** moved further from the distal end of the adapter **110**, while remaining tethered to the insertion device **104** via the extending members **112**. This widens the field of view of the endoscope vision system relative to the clip **102** and the tissue clipped thereby and allows for movement and/or angling of the endoscope **106** relative to the clip **102** to enable more extensive observation of the placement and/or position of the clip **102** relative to the target tissue from different angles, etc. As described below, if the user determines the position of the clip **102** is incorrect or sub-optimal, the user may move the endoscope **106** distally to a position adjacent to the clip **102** and then retract the clip **102** back over the distal end of the adapter **110** toward the open insertion configuration by drawing the extending members **112** proximally relative to the adapter **110**.

(19) The user may then reposition the endoscope **106** and the clip **102** and repeat these steps so that the placement and/or position of the clip **102** relative to a target tissue may be adjusted, as desired, until a desired position of the clip **102** clipped over a target portion of tissue is achieved. That is, when the operator determines in the review configuration that the clip **102** is not positioned as desired, the clip **102** may be re-opened and removed from the clipped tissue so that the device can be re-positioned until the clip **102** is closed over the desired portion of tissue as desired. Once it is determined that the clip **102** has been clipped over the desired tissue, the enlarged distal end **116** of each of the extending members **112** is laterally relative to the clip **102** (i.e., transverse to a proximal-distal direction) so that the extending members **112** no longer extend through the second portion **126** of the opening **118**, but pass through the first portion **124** of the opening **118**.

(20) As can be seen in FIG. 3, the first portion **124** of the opening **118** is wider than the second portion **126** so that the enlarged distal end **116** can pass through the first portion **124** to separate the extending members **112** from the clip **102** while the narrower second portion **126** of the opening **118** is sized to prevent the enlarged distal member **116** from passing therethrough. Removing the enlarged distal ends **116** from the openings **118** disengages the clip **102** from the device so that the device and the endoscope may be withdrawn from the body leaving the clip **102** in the body clipped over the target tissue. As will be understood by those of skill in the art and as will be described in further detail below, movement of the clip **102** between the insertion configuration, the initial deployed configuration, the review configuration and the final deployed configuration may be controlled via a user interface **120** which, in one embodiment, as shown in FIGS. 6-9, is coupled proximal ends **150** of the extending members **112**.

(21) The clip **102** includes a pair of jaws **114**, with a first end **142** of one of the jaws **114** being connected to the first end **142** of the other jaw **114** via a first hinge **140** and a second end **144** of the one jaw **114** connected the second end **144** of the other jaw **114** via a second hinge **140**. In one embodiment, each of the jaws **114** extends along a curve from the first end **142** to the second end **144**. In one embodiment, the hinges **140** have a natural bias (e.g., a spring bias), biasing the jaws **114** toward the initial deployed configuration in which the jaws **114** are moved toward one another, in a closed configuration to clip tissue received therebetween. Either or both of the jaws **114** may include gripping features.

(22) If both jaws **114** have such gripping features **138** such as, for example, teeth, in the initial deployed configuration, the gripping features **138** of one of the jaws **114** contact the gripping features **138** of the other jaw **114**. In particular, in the initial deployed configuration, the jaws **114** are moved toward one another to grip tissue received therebetween via the gripping features **138**. However, when the clip **102** is mounted over the adapter **110** in the insertion configuration, the jaws **114** extend about opposing portions of the adapter **110** so that an exterior surface **122** of the adapter **110** maintains the clip **102** open with the jaws **114** separated from one another. Thus, when the clip **102** is mounted over the adapter **110** the jaws **114** are spread apart from one another so that tissue drawn into the adapter is received between the jaws **114**.

(23) Tissue to be clipped is held within the adapter **110** as the clip **102** is moved distally off of the

adapter **110**. This frees the jaws **114** to close under the natural bias of the hinges **140** clipping the tissue drawn into the adapter **110**. It will be understood by those of skill in the art that the hinges **140** and/or jaws **114** of the clips **102** may be formed of any of a variety of materials so long as the hinges **140** bias the jaws **114** toward the initial deployed configuration, as described above, and so that the bias is sufficiently strong to maintain the clip **102** clipped over target tissue after the clip **102** has been finally deployed (e.g., until edges of an opening in tissue drawn together by the clip **102** have healed together). In one example, portions of the clip **102** (e.g., the hinges **140**) are formed of a shape memory alloy such as, for example, Nitinol to provide and/or add to the bias toward the closed configuration.

(24) According to an exemplary embodiment, as described above and as shown in FIG. 3, each of the openings **118** extends through the corresponding jaw **114** from a first surface **146** of the clip **102** which, in the insertion configuration, faces the adapter **110**, to a second surface **148** of the clip **102** which faces away from the adapter **110** in the insertion configuration. In one embodiment, each opening **118** extends through the corresponding jaw **114**, midway between the first and second ends **142**, **144** thereof, so that the openings **118** are opposite one another (e.g., extending through diametrically opposed portions of the clip **102**).

(25) As indicated above first portion **124** of each opening **118** is open to the second portion **126** so that the extending members **112** can be slid laterally through the openings **118** from the second portion **126** to the first portion **124**. The first portion **124** is sized and shaped to permit a passage of the enlarged distal end **116** of a corresponding one of the extending members **112** therethrough. The second portion **126** is smaller and shaped so that, if the enlarged distal end **116** has been passed through the first portion **124** and the extending member **112** is slid from the first portion **124** to the second portion **126**, the enlarged distal end **116** is engaged with the portions of the jaw **114** surrounding the second portion **126** preventing the extending member **112** from being withdrawn from the opening **118**. Thus, the enlarged distal end **116** will engage the second portion **126** (e.g., abutting the second surface **148**), when proximal tension is applied along the extending member **112**.

(26) In one embodiment, the enlarged distal end **116** and the first portion **124** of the opening **118** are circular with a diameter of the first portion **124** larger than that of the enlarged distal end **116**. In this embodiment, the second portion **126** is configured as an elongated slot having a width smaller than a diameter of the enlarged distal end **116**. It will be understood by those of skill in the art, however, that the opening **118** may have any of a variety of shapes and sizes so long as the key-shaped opening **118** includes a first portion **124** sized, shaped and configured to permit passage of the enlarged distal end **116** therethrough and a second portion **126** sized, shaped and configured to prevent passage of the enlarged distal end **116** therethrough.

(27) In one embodiment, the second portion **126** of the opening **118** extends from the first portion **124** toward an exterior edge of the jaw **114** (away from the gripping features **138**). Thus, according to an exemplary embodiment, the extending members **112** are released from the clip **102** by moving the extending members **112** and the enlarged distal ends **116** through the second portions **126** laterally inward toward a longitudinal axis of the endoscope **106** until the enlarged distal ends **116** reach the first portions **124**. Once the extending members **112** extend through the first portions **124**, the enlarged distal ends **116** are drawn proximally through the first portions **124** of the openings **118** so that the extending members **112** are released from the clip **102**.

(28) It will be understood by those of skill in the art, however, that the opening **118** may have any of a variety of orientations relative to each of the jaws **114**, so long as the orientation of the opening **118** extending through each of the jaws **114** corresponds to a configured movement of a corresponding one of the extending members **112** relative to the clip **102** during movement of the system **100** from the review configuration toward the final deployed configuration. For example, where one or more of the distal ends **116** of the extending members **112** is configured to be moved laterally outward relative to the longitudinal axis of the endoscope **106**, a corresponding one of the

opening **118** will include a second portion **126** extending from the first portion **124** toward a side of the corresponding one of the jaws **114** including the gripping features **138**. Those skilled in the art will understand also that the openings **118** may be configured differently from one another so long as the user can manipulate the extending members **112** so that the enlarged distal ends are simultaneously or serially movable into the first portions **124** of the openings **118** when it is desired to finally deploy the clip **102**.

(29) As discussed above, the clip **102** may be mounted to the insertion device **104**, as shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, which may include any standard endoscope **106**. The clip **102** may be mounted to the endoscope **106** via the adapter **110**, which is sized, shaped and configured to be mounted over the distal end **108** of the endoscope **106** or any other desired insertion device. As will be understood by those of skill in the art, the endoscope **106** of this embodiment is configured to be inserted through a body lumen to a target area within the lumen and thus, must be sufficiently flexible to navigate through even tortuous paths of the body lumen. The adapter **110** extends from a proximal end **128** to a distal end **130** and includes a channel **132** extending therethrough to an open distal end through which tissue may be drawn into the channel **132**.

(30) A proximal portion **129** of the adapter **110** is configured to be mounted over the distal end **108** of the endoscope **106** while a distal portion **131** of the adapter is configured to receive the clip **102** thereover in the insertion configuration. The proximal portion **129** of the adapter **110** may be mounted to the endoscope **106** via, for example, a friction fit, so that the channel **132** of the adapter **110** is substantially longitudinally aligned with a longitudinal axis of the endoscope **106** open to a working channel of the endoscope (e.g., so that suction or a grasper may be inserted therethrough to draw tissue into the channel **132**) and permitting a vision system of the endoscope **106** to visualize the clip **102** and any tissue clipped or to be clipped thereby. In another embodiment, to enhance the visibility of the tissue and/or the clip **102**, the adapter **110** may be formed of a transparent material.

(31) In one embodiment, the proximal portion **129** of the adapter **110** of this embodiment includes a pair of holes **134** extending longitudinally through a wall **136** thereof. Each of the holes **134** is configured to slidably receive a corresponding one of the extending members **112**. As will be described in further detail below, the extending members **112** are received within the holes **134** so that distal ends **116** extend distally from the holes **134** to be coupled to the clip **102**, which, in the insertion configuration, is mounted over the distal portion **131** of the adapter **110**. According to an exemplary embodiment, each of the holes **134** extends through the wall **136** of the proximal portion **129** along an axis angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter **110**.

(32) In one embodiment, the axes of the holes **134** are angled with respect to the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** so that the central axes of the holes **134** intersect with the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** distally of the distal end of the adapter **110**. In this embodiment, the holes **134** are angled toward one another from the proximal end **128** of the adapter **110** toward the distal end **130** of the adapter **110**. Thus, when the extending members **112** are moved distally through the holes **134**, the enlarged distal ends **116** thereof are moved laterally inward, toward one another and toward the longitudinal axis of the endoscope **106**. As will be described in further detail below, lateral movement of the enlarged distal ends **116** facilitates release of the clip **102** from the review configuration to the final deployed configuration.

(33) Although the exemplary embodiments show and describe the holes **134** extending along axes which intersect with the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** (and with one another) distally of the adapter **110**, it will be understood by those of skill in the art that the holes **134** may extend through the adapter **110** at any of a variety of angles relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** so long as the holes **134** angle the extending members **112** in such a way as to permit the enlarged distal ends **116** to be moved in laterally relative to the endoscope **106** to facilitate release of the enlarged distal ends **116** from the openings **118** of the clip **102** (e.g., as the extending members **112** are moved distally relative to the adapter **110** and the clip **102**). For example, in another

embodiment, axes of the holes **134** intersect with the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** proximally of the adapter **110**. In yet another embodiment, an axis of a first one of the holes **134** intersects with the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** distally of the adapter **110** while an axis of a second one of the pair of holes **134** intersects with the longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** proximally thereof.

(34) An outer diameter of the distal portion **131** of the adapter **110** is sized, shaped and configured to receive the clip **102** thereover, in the insertion configuration. In one exemplary embodiment, the distal portion **131** tapers toward the distal end **130** so that the bias of the clip **102** toward the initial deployed configuration aids in drawing the clip **102** distally over the adapter **110** (i.e., the closing force of the clip **102** draws the clip **102** distally as the jaws **114** slide over the tapered surface of the adapter **110**). When the clip **102** is mounted over the distal portion **131** of the adapter **110**, with each the jaws **114** spread apart and extending over opposing portions of the adapter **110**, an exterior surface of the adapter **110** prevents the jaws **114** from closing (i.e., constrains the clip **102** toward the insertion configuration with the jaws **114** open to receive tissue drawn into the adapter **110**).

(35) The clip **102** remains mounted over the adapter **110** in the insertion configuration so long as proximally directed tension applied to the extending members **112** and friction between the clip **102** and the adapter **110** is maintained at a predetermined level. When tension is removed from the extending members **112** and/or a distally directed force is applied to the extending members **112**, the natural bias of the clip **102** draws the jaws **114** toward one another and the clip **102** is moved distally over the tapered surface of the adapter **110** until the clip **102** slides distally off of the adapter **110**.

(36) The distal portion **131** of the adapter **110** of one embodiment includes a plurality of longitudinally extending flat portions **154** distributed about the circumference of the exterior surface **122** of the adapter **110**. Each of the flat portions **154** extends along at least a portion of a length of the distal portion **131** and covers a portion of a perimeter (e.g., circumference) of the distal portion **131**. The flat portions **154** which may be equally sized and separated from one another about the circumference of the distal portion **131** provide clearance between portions of the clip **102** and the adapter **110** which reduces friction between the clip **102** and the distal portion **131** of the adapter **110** to facilitate a movement of the clip **102** between the insertion configuration and the initial deployed configuration.

(37) The distal portion **131** of the adapter **110** of this embodiment also includes a plurality of projections **156** extending radially into the channel **132** of the adapter **110**. In one embodiment, each of the projections **156** extends from a curved portion **158** of the distal portion **131** extending between adjacent flat portions **154**. In one exemplary embodiment, a distal face **160** of each these curved portions **158** is angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter **110** so that, when the clip **102** is drawn proximally from the initial deployed configuration, the jaws **114** abut the distal face **160** and the angle of these projections **156** facilitates the re-opening of the jaws **114** against their natural bias, so that the clip **102** may be drawn proximally over the adapter **110** opening the jaws **114** and returning the clip **102** to the insertion configuration. That is, the jaws **114** slide proximally over the projections **156** to facilitate the opening of the jaws **114** so that the clip **102** is released from the clipped tissue and slid proximally back onto the adapter **110**.

(38) As described above, the insertion device **104** includes extending members **112** extending along a length of the endoscope **106** from proximal ends **150** which remain accessible to the user via, for example, a user interface **120** outside the body, to the enlarged distal ends **116**. In one embodiment, the insertion device **104** includes two extending members **112**, each which is configured to be releasably coupled to a corresponding one of the jaws **114**. In one embodiment, the enlarged distal end **116** may be ball shaped. The ball-shaped enlarged distal end **116** has a diameter larger than a remaining length of the extending member **112** (i.e., a portion of the extending member **112** extending proximally from the enlarged distal end **116**).

(39) In this embodiment, the diameter of the ball-shaped distal end **116** is smaller than the diameter

of the correspondingly sized and shaped first portion **124** of the opening **118**. The width of the second portion **126**, is larger than the diameter of the portion of the extending members **112** extending proximally from the enlarged distal ends **116** so that the extending members **112** may be moved through the second portions **126** of the openings **118** to the first portions **124**. The width of the second portion **126** is smaller than the diameter of the ball-shaped enlarged distal end **116** so that, when the extending member **112** extends through the second portion **126**, as shown in FIG. 4, a remaining length of the extending member **112** proximal of the enlarged distal end **116** is slidable through the second portion **126**, while the enlarged distal end **116** is prevented from passing therethrough. Thus, the enlarged distal end **116** engages the second surface **148**, releasably engaging the extending member **112** to the jaw **114** of the clip **102**.

(40) It will be understood by those of skill in the art that, in the insertion configuration, each of the enlarged distal ends **116** engages a corresponding one of the openings **118** and abuts the second surface **148** of the corresponding jaw **114** while a portion of each of the extending members **112** extending proximally therefrom is held between the exterior surface **122** of the adapter **110** and the corresponding one of the jaws **114**. Thus, in the insertion configuration, the extending members **112** are further prevented from being inadvertently disengaged from the clip **102**. In an exemplary embodiment, the extending members **112** are formed as flexible strands, filaments or coils formed of, for example, a metal or polymer.

(41) Each extending member **112** in this embodiment extends through, for example, an outer shaft **152** extending along a length of the endoscope **106** from a proximal end **162** connected to a portion of the user interface **120** to a distal end **164** connected to the adapter **110**. In particular, the distal ends **164** of the outer shafts **152** are connected to the proximal end **128** of the adapter **110** so that each outer shaft **152** is aligned with a corresponding one of the holes **134** of the adapter **110**. Thus, each extending member **112** extends through a corresponding one of the outer shafts **152** and the holes **134** so that the extending member **112** is longitudinally movable therewithin, relative to the endoscope **106**, to control movement of the clip **102** relative to the endoscope **106**. The outer shafts **152** also reduce interference with movement of the extending members **112** by tissue surrounding the endoscope **106** and protects this tissue from friction or other damage that might occur as the extending members **112** are moved proximally and distally relative to the endoscope **106**.

(42) In one embodiment, each of the outer shafts **152** (and the corresponding one of the extending members **112**) extends along diametrically opposed portions of the endoscope **106**. Each of the outer shafts **152** in this embodiment is substantially longitudinally aligned with one of the holes **134** of the adapter **110** and one of the openings **118** of a corresponding one of the jaws **114** so that, when the clip **102** is mounted over the adapter **110**, the enlarged distal ends **116** of the extending members **112** extend distally from the holes **134** of the adapter **110** to releasably engage the jaws **114** of the clip **102**. It will be understood by those skilled in the art, however, that any arrangement of the outer shafts **152** may be employed so long as the extending members **112** are slidably housed therein and are delivered to desired locations on the clip **102** as described above.

(43) According to an exemplary embodiment, as shown in FIGS. 6-9, the user interface **120** includes a handle member **166** and a spool **168** slidably mounted thereover. The handle member **166** is connected to the proximal ends **162** of the outer shafts **152** while the spool **168** is connected to the proximal ends **150** of the extending members **112**. Thus, moving the spool **168** longitudinally over the handle member **166** correspondingly moves the extending members **112** longitudinally relative to the endoscope **106**. Since the clip **102** is releasably coupled to the enlarged distal ends **116** of the extending members **112**, the spool **168** may be moved relative to the handle member **166** to move the clip **102** between the insertion configuration, the initial deployed configuration, the review configuration and the final deployed configuration.

(44) In one embodiment, the proximal ends **162** of the outer shafts **152** are connected to the handle member **166** via an end cap **170** attached to a distal end **172** of the handle member **166**. Proximal ends **162** may be fixed within the end cap **170** via any of a number of different mechanisms. For

example, the proximal ends **162** may be crimp attached, welded or adhered to the end cap **170**.

(45) In one embodiment, the spool **168** is slidably mounted over the handle member **166** via an elongated slot **174** extending longitudinally along the handle member **166**. The spool **168** includes, for example, a rod **176** extending across a channel **178** of the spool **168**, the rod **176** received within the elongated slot **174** to permit a longitudinal slidable movement of the spool **168** relative to the handle member **166**. The proximal ends **150** of the extending members **112** are affixed to the rod **176** so that a longitudinal movement of the spool **168** relative to the handle member **166** correspondingly moves the clip **102** relative to the endoscope **106** between the insertion, initial deployed, review and final deployed configurations.

(46) According to an exemplary method for tissue closure utilizing the clipping system **100**, the clip **102** may be inserted through a body lumen such as, for example, the GI tract, to a target area within the body lumen via the insertion device **104** which, in one embodiment, may include the endoscope **106**. As described above, in the insertion configuration, the clip **102** is mounted to the distal end **108** of the endoscope **106** via the adapter **110**, so that the jaws **114** are separated from one another toward the open configuration. The clip **102** is guided to the target area via the visualization system of the endoscope and positioned over a target tissue. A suction force and/or tissue graspers may be applied through a working channel of the endoscope **106** so that the target tissue may be drawn into the channel **132** of the adapter **110**. Thus, when the clip **102** is moved toward the initial deployed configuration by releasing a tension along the extending members **112** (e.g., moving the extending members **112** proximally relative to the endoscope **106**), the clip **102** slides distally along the adapter **110** toward the biased closed configuration to grip the target tissue.

(47) It will be understood by those of skill in the art that suctioning and/or gripping of the tissue in this initial deployed configuration may obstruct an imaging/optical lens of the endoscope **106** so that the user is unable to visualize and/or confirm whether a desired target tissue has been properly clipped. Thus, as shown in FIG. 4, the clip **102** may be moved toward the review configuration by drawing the endoscope **106** distally relative to the clip **102**, while a tension is maintained along the extending members **112** so that the clip **102** remains clipped on the tissue. A distance between the adapter **110** and the clip **102** widens a field of view of the endoscope **106** so that the clip **102**, and the tissue gripped thereby, may be viewed via the optical/visualization system of the endoscope **106**.

(48) If, upon visualization, the user determines that the clip **102** requires an adjustment and/or a repositioning relative to the target tissue, the extending members **112** may be translated proximally relative to the endoscope **106** until the clip **102** is moved proximally over the adapter **110**, as described above, toward the open insertion configuration. As the clip **102** is moved toward the open configuration, the tissue gripped thereby is released, permitting the clip **102** to be repositioned over the target tissue, as desired. The clip **102** may then once again moved toward the initial deployed configuration, and then again toward the review configuration. This process may be repeated, as necessary, until the user is able to visually confirm that the clip **102** has been clipped over the target tissue, as desired.

(49) Once the user confirms that the target tissue has been clipped, as desired, the clip **102** may be moved from the review configuration toward the final deployed configuration, by releasing the clip **102** from the extending members **112**. As described above, in one embodiment, the extending members **112** may be moved distally relative to the clip **102** so that the extending members **112** are moved distally through the holes **134** of the adapter **110**. As described above, the holes **134** of the adapter **110** are angled with respect to the longitudinal axis of the adapter so that the distal movement of the extending members **112** relative to the adapter **110** moves the enlarged distal ends **116** of the extending member **112** in a lateral direction relative to the clip **102**.

(50) In one embodiment, the distal ends **116** are moved laterally toward one another and relative to the clip **102** so that the enlarged distal ends **116** are moved from the second portions **126** of the keyhole openings **118** toward the first portions **124** of the keyhole openings **118**, as shown in FIG.

5. The enlarged distal ends **116** are sized and shaped to be smaller than the first portions **124** so that, once they are received within the first portions **124**, the extending members **112** (and the insertion device **104**) may be withdrawn proximally therefrom to release the clip **102** in the final deployed configuration.

(51) In one embodiment, each of the distal portions of the extending members **112** includes a bendable portion **117** configured to bend radially inward relative to a longitudinal axis of the channel **132** when a predetermined distal force is applied to the extending member **112**. In the initial deployed configuration, as shown in FIG. 4, the extending members **112** and the bendable portions **117** are substantially straight, i.e., the bendable portions **117** extend through the second portions **126** of the keyhole openings **118** and are not bent radially inward relative to the longitudinal axis of the channel **132**. Thus, when a user wants to deploy the clip **102** of this embodiment, the extending members **112** are advanced distally to move the clip **102** off the cap **110**, as described above, so that the clip **102** closes over target tissue. The user then pushes the extending members **112** distally against the tissue to bend the bendable portions **117** radially inward, as shown in FIG. 10, so that the enlarged distal ends **116** move radially inward through the keyhole openings **118** toward the first portions **124** of the keyhole openings **118**. As described and shown with respect to FIG. 5, the enlarged distal ends **116** are sized and shaped to be smaller than the first portions **124** so that, once the enlarged distal ends **116** are received within the first portions **124**, the extending members **112** (and the insertion device **104**) may be withdrawn proximally therefrom to release the clip **102** from the device **100** so that the clip **102** may be left in the final deployed configuration clipped over target tissue while the rest of the device **100** is withdrawn from the body.

(52) In a further exemplary embodiment, the bendable portions **117** are pre-shaped so that, when not constrained by the holes **134**, the bendable portions **117** bend radially inward relative to a longitudinal axis of the channel **132**. Thus, when a user wants to deploy the clip **102** of this embodiment, the extending members **112** are advanced distally to move the clip **102** off the cap **110**, as described above, so that the clip **102** closes over target tissue and the bendable portions **117**, now unconstrained by the holes **134**, bend radially inward (i.e., so that the enlarged distal ends **116** move toward one another). The user then pushes the extending members **112** distally against the tissue to further bend the bendable portions **117** radially inward so that the enlarged distal ends **116** move radially inward through the keyhole openings **118** toward the first portions **124** of the keyhole openings **118**, as shown in FIG. 10.

(53) In a further exemplary embodiment, only one of the extending members **112** includes a bendable portion **117** as described above, while in another exemplary embodiment, the distal portions of each of the extending members **112** is substantially straight until the enlarged distal ends **116** are pressed distally against the tissue to bend the distal portions of the extending members radially inward to move the enlarged distal ends **116** into the first portions **124** of the keyhole openings **118** in a manner similar to that described above.

(54) It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications may be made in the present disclosure, without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Furthermore, those skilled in the art will understand that the features of any of the various embodiments may be combined in any manner that is not inconsistent with the description and/or the functionality of the embodiments.

Claims

1. A clipping system for treating tissue, comprising: an adapter including a proximal portion configured to be mounted over a distal end of an insertion device and a distal portion extending distally from the proximal portion; a clip configured to be mounted over the distal portion of the adapter, the clip including first and second jaws connected to one another such that the first and second jaws are movable between an insertion configuration, in which the first and second jaws

extend about opposing portions of the distal portion of the adapter and are separated from one another to receive tissue therebetween, and an initial deployed configuration, in which the clip is moved distally off of the adapter so that the first and second jaws are drawn toward one another to grip tissue therebetween, the first and second jaws being biased toward the initial deployed configuration and the first jaw including a keyhole opening extending therethrough; and a first extending member configured to be releasably coupled to the clip and movably connected to the adapter, the first extending member including an enlarged distal end configured to releasably engage the keyhole opening of the first jaw, the enlarged distal end having a width which is smaller than a width of a first portion of the keyhole opening and larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening so that, when a portion of the first extending member proximal of the enlarged distal end is received within the second portion, the first extending member is engaged therewithin to permit the withdrawal of the adapter proximally away from the clip while the first extending member remains coupled to the clip to place the system in a review configuration in which the clip is physically separated from the adapter to enhance visual observation of the clip, the first extending member being operable to retract the clip proximally over the adapter so that the clip is forced open as the clip is retracted over the adapter freeing the clip from tissue on which it had been clipped, wherein the proximal portion of the adapter includes a first hole extending longitudinally through a wall thereof to slidably receive the first extending member therein, the first hole extending through the wall along an axis that is angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter so that a distal movement of the first extending member relative to the adapter moves the enlarged distal end in a lateral direction relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the axis of the first hole intersects the longitudinal axis of the adapter at a point distal of a distal end of the adapter so that, when the first extending member is moved distally relative to the adapter, the enlarged distal end is moved in an inward lateral direction toward the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

3. The system of claim 2, wherein the second portion of the keyhole extends from the first portion toward an exterior edge of the first jaw.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the enlarged distal end of the first extending member is ball shaped.

5. The system of claim 4, wherein the first portion of the keyhole is substantially circular and the second portion of the keyhole is slotted.

6. The system of claim 1, further comprising a second extending member configured to be releasably coupled to the second jaw of the clip via a keyhole opening extending through the second jaw, the second extending member including an enlarged distal end configured to releasably engage the keyhole opening of the second jaw, the enlarged distal end of the second extending member having a width that is smaller than a width of a first portion of the keyhole opening of the second jaw and larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening of the second jaw.

7. The system of claim 6, wherein the adapter includes a second hole extending longitudinally through the wall thereof to slidably receive the second extending member therein, the second hole extending through the wall along an axis that is angled with respect to the longitudinal axis of the adapter so that a distal movement of the second extending member relative to the adapter moves the enlarged distal end in a lateral direction relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

8. A clipping system for treating tissue, comprising: an endoscope extending longitudinally from a proximal end to a distal end; an adapter including a proximal portion and a distal portion, the proximal portion configured to be mounted over the distal end of the endoscope so that a channel of the adapter is aligned with a channel of the endoscope; a clip configured to be mounted over the distal portion of the adapter, the clip including first and second jaws connected to one another such that the first and second jaws are movable between an insertion configuration, in which the first and second jaws extend about opposing portions of the distal portion of the adapter and are separated from one another to receive tissue therebetween, and an initial deployed configuration, in

which the clip is moved distally off of the adapter so that the first and second jaws are drawn toward one another to grip tissue therebetween, the first and second jaws being biased toward the initial deployed configuration, each of the first and second jaws including a keyhole opening extending therethrough; and first and second extending members configured to be releasably coupled to the clip and movably connected to the adapter, each of the first and second extending members extending from a proximal end accessible a user to an enlarged distal end configured to releasably engage the keyhole opening of a corresponding one of the first and second jaws, the enlarged distal end of each of the first and second extending members having a width which is smaller than a width of a first portion of the keyhole opening of the corresponding one of the first and second jaws and larger than a second portion of the keyhole opening of the corresponding one of the first and second jaws so that, when a portion of the first and second extending members proximal of the enlarged distal ends is received within the second portion of the keyhole openings, the first and second extending members engage the clip so that a longitudinal movement of the first and second extending members relative to the endoscope moves the clip between the insertion configuration, the initial deployed configuration and a review configuration in which the clip is physically separated from the adapter to enhance visual observation of the clip, wherein the proximal portion of the adapter includes first and second holes extending longitudinally through a wall thereof to slidably receive the first and second extending members, respectively, therein, each of the first and second holes extending through the wall along a axis that is angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter so that a distal movement of the first and second extending members relative to the adapter moves the enlarged distal ends of the first and second extending members in a lateral direction relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein central axes of the first and second holes intersect the longitudinal axis of the adapter distally of the adapter so that, when the first and second extending members are moved distally relative to the adapter, the enlarged distal ends are moved laterally inward toward the longitudinal axis of the adapter.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein the second portion of each of the keyholes extends from the first toward an exterior edge of a corresponding one of the jaws.

11. The system of claim 8, further comprising first and second outer shafts extending along the endoscope and configured to slidably receive the first and second extending members, respectively, therein, each of the first and second outer shafts extending from a proximal end to a distal end attached to the adapter in alignment with a corresponding one of the first and second holes.

12. The system of claim 11, further comprising a user interface connected to the proximal ends of the first and second outer shafts and the proximal ends of the first and second extending members.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the user interface includes a handle member and a spool slidably mounted thereover, the handle member attached to the proximal end of the first and second outer shafts and the spool connected to the proximal ends of the first and second extending member so that a longitudinal movement of the spool relative to the handle member correspondingly moves the clip relative to the endoscope.

14. A method for treating tissue, comprising: inserting a clip to a target area in a body lumen via an endoscope, the clip mounted over a distal end of the endoscope, via an adapter, in an open insertion configuration in which jaws of the clip are separated from one another; drawing tissue into a channel of the adapter and between jaws of the clip; moving the clip from the open insertion configuration toward an initial deployed configuration by releasing a tension along extending members coupled to the clip so that the jaws revert to a biased closed configuration, in which the jaws extend toward one another to grip the tissue received therebetween, the extending members releasably coupled to the clip via enlarged distal ends releasably engaged to keyhole openings extending through each of the jaws, the enlarged distal end of each of the extending members having a width smaller than a first portion of a corresponding one of the keyhole openings and larger than a second portion of the corresponding one of the keyhole openings; drawing the

endoscope proximally away from the clip, while the extending members remain coupled to the clip, toward a review configuration in which a visualization of the clip via the endoscope is enhanced; and moving the clip from the review configuration toward a final deployed configuration by moving the extending members distally through holes extending through the adapter, the holes extending through the adapter along central axes angled with respect to a longitudinal axis of the adapter so that, moving the extending members distally relative to the adapter causes the enlarged distal ends thereof to be moved laterally relative to the longitudinal axis of the adapter to disengage the extending members from the keyhole openings.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein, when it is determined that the clip requires repositioning, moving the extending members proximally relative to the endoscope until the clip is drawn proximally over the adapter toward the open insertion configuration and repositioning the clip over the target tissue.

16. The method of claim 14, wherein, during movement of the clip from the review configuration toward the final deployed configuration, each of the extending members are moved from the second portion toward the first portion of a corresponding one of the keyholes so that the enlarged distal end is passed proximally through the first portion to release the clip.

17. The method of claim 14, wherein, during movement of the clip from the review configuration toward the final deployed configuration, the enlarged distal ends of the extending members are moved laterally inward toward one another to disengage the enlarged distal ends from the keyhole openings.
